I created a genie pot in cherry (*Prunus avium*) after seeing a demonstration by Nikos Siragas

My lyre clock – left – was runner-up in the 1999 International Woodworking Show at the NEC

HANDY HINTS

- Never buy a lathe on impulse as I did, join a club, ask questions and do your research
- Beginners should learn to use and sharpen the basic tools for spindle turning. Spindle turning will teach you tool presentation and manipulation and prepare you for future challenges in woodturning
- Always wear the appropriate personal protection equipment; you only get one set of eyes and lungs
- Ensure the blank you are about to turn is securely mounted before you start the lathe
- Never push a blunt tool, sharpen frequently especially before that final cut. Otherwise it can end up in an 'oh, dear' moment – or a design opportunity
- Pay attention to finishing; it can make or mar a piece of work
- Make a drawing – to size or to scale – of any work involving several parts. It can help you decide how you mount each piece on the lathe and highlight any problems you may encounter
- Never stop learning. Use your eyes and see the shapes in architecture. Visit museums and other exhibitions

"Never push a blunt tool, sharpen frequently especially before that final cut. Otherwise you can end up with an 'oh, dear' moment – or a design opportunity"

A sewing kit made from sapele (*Entandrophragma cylindricum*) and beech (*Fagus sylvatica*)

A poppy from the 2014 remembrance installation at the Tower of London within a flower arrangement in a sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*) vase

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